Preparing Insoluble Salts

Exam code: 0620 & 0971

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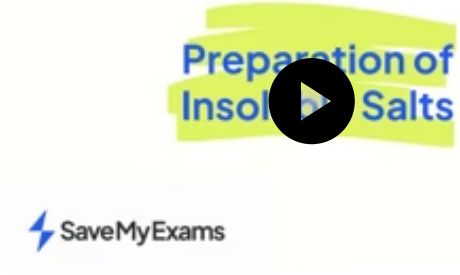

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Preparing insoluble salts

Help me understand

Extended tier only

- Insoluble salts can be prepared using a **precipitation reaction**
- The solid salt obtained is the precipitate
- To successfully use this method:
  - The solid salt (precipitate) being formed must be insoluble in water
  - The reactants must be soluble

Using two soluble reactants

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

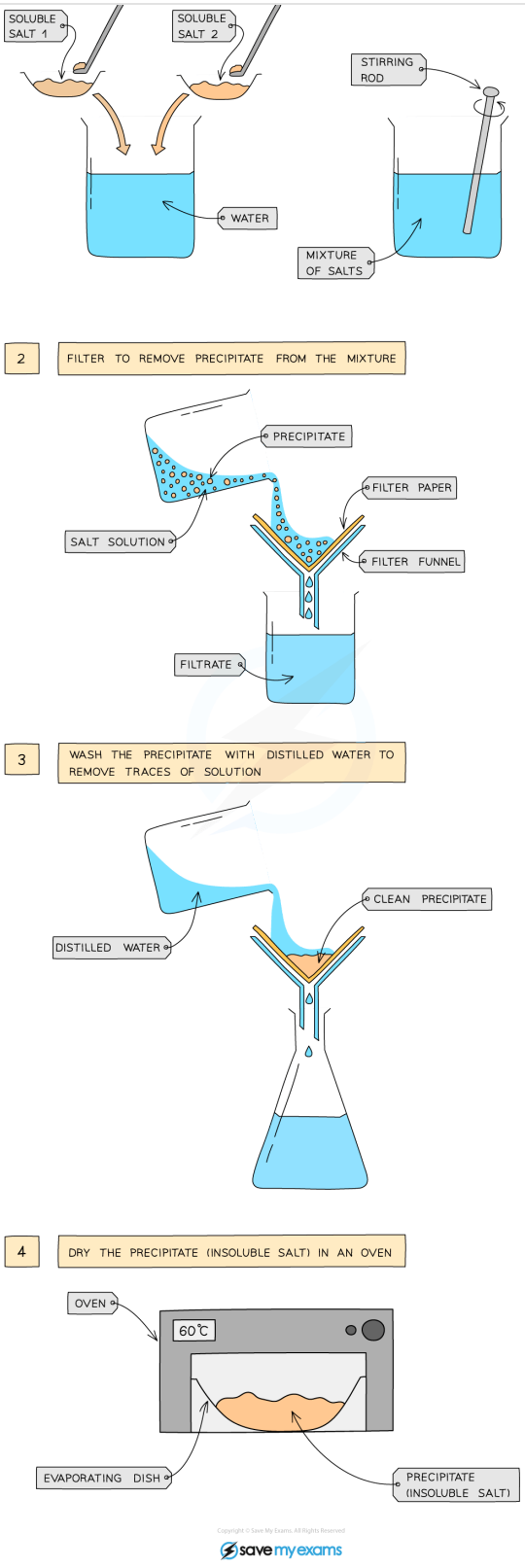

Diagram showing the filtration of the mixture to remove the precipitate

Method

- Make aqueous solutions of two soluble salts
- Mix together using a stirring rod in a beaker

- Leave to dry (for example in a warm oven)

Example: Preparation of pure, dry, solid lead(II) sulfate using a precipitation reaction

- Dissolve lead(II) nitrate and potassium sulfate in water
- Mix together using a stirring rod in a beaker
- Filter to remove the precipitate from the mixture
- Wash the precipitate with distilled water to remove traces of potassium nitrate solution
- Leave to dry (for example in a warm oven)

lead(II) nitrate + potassium sulfate → lead(II) sulfate + potassium nitrate

$$Pb(NO_3)_2\,(aq) + K_2SO_4\,(aq) \rightarrow PbSO_4\,(s) + 2KNO_3\,(aq)$$

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